

USB Attach / Detach Handling — Design Document

Project: com.zebra.rfid.usb

Target Device: Zebra RFD40 RFID Sled (VID 1504)

Min SDK: 34 (Android 14)

Overview

Android exposes USB host events via the UsbManager system service and broadcasts two key actions:

Action	Constant	When fired
android.hardware.usb.action.USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED	USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED	USB device plugged in
android.hardware.usb.action.USB_DEVICE_DETACHED	USB_DEVICE_DETACHED	USB device unplugged

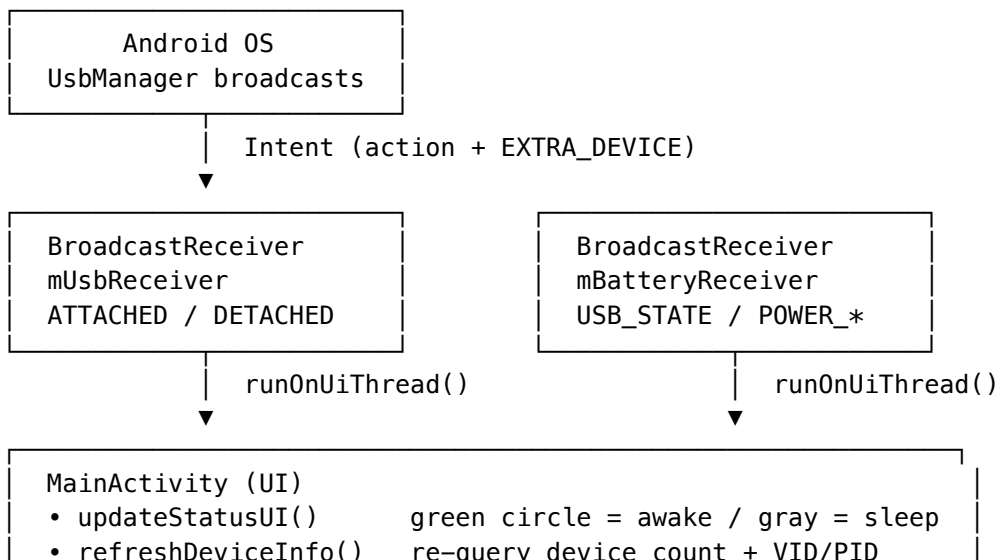
In addition to host attach/detach, the app performs **active USB transport and power-state monitoring** using three more broadcasts:

Action	Constant	When fired
android.hardware.usb.action.USB_STATE	USB_STATE (local const)	USB client/transport configuration changes
android.intent.action.ACTION_POWER_CONNECTED	POWER_CONNECTED	Power/USB cable connected
android.intent.action.ACTION_POWER_DISCONNECTED	POWER_DISCONNECTED	Power/USB cable disconnected

The app uses **two** runtime BroadcastReceivers:

- mUsbReceiver — host attach/detach events (device count + awake/sleep UI).
- mBatteryReceiver — USB transport mode + power connect/disconnect monitoring.

Architecture



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|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • updateUsbModeFromIntent() decode transport mode • appendLog() timestamped event log |
|--|

Both receivers are registered in onCreate() and unregistered in onDestroy().

1. IntentFilter Registration

Register the receiver **programmatically** (not via manifest) so it receives events while the app is in the foreground.

```
IntentFilter filter = new IntentFilter();
filter.addAction(UsbManager.ACTION_USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED); // "android.hardware.usb.action.USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED"
filter.addAction(UsbManager.ACTION_USB_DEVICE_DETACHED); // "android.hardware.usb.action.USB_DEVICE_DETACHED"
filter.addAction(UsbManager.ACTION_USB_ACCESSORY_ATTACHED);
filter.addAction(UsbManager.ACTION_USB_ACCESSORY_DETACHED);
registerReceiver(mUsbReceiver, filter);
```

Important: Always pair registerReceiver() in onCreate() with unregisterReceiver() in onDestroy() to avoid memory leaks.

```
@Override
protected void onDestroy() {
    super.onDestroy();
    unregisterReceiver(mUsbReceiver);
    unregisterReceiver(mBatteryReceiver);
}
```

2. BroadcastReceiver Implementation

```
BroadcastReceiver mUsbReceiver = new BroadcastReceiver() {
    public void onReceive(Context context, Intent intent) {
        String action = intent.getAction();
        if (action == null) return;

        Log.d(TAG, "USB action: " + action);

        // — DETACH —
        if (UsbManager.ACTION_USB_DEVICE_DETACHED.equals(action)) {
            Log.d(TAG, "USB device detached");

            // EXTRA_DEVICE is available on detach (device already gone from bus)
            UsbDevice device = intent.getParcelableExtra(UsbManager.EXTRA_DEVICE);
            if (device != null) {
                Log.d(TAG, "EXTRA_DEVICE Name=" + device.getDeviceName()
                    + device.getProductName() + device.getDeviceId());
            }

            runOnUiThread(() -> {
                refreshDeviceInfo(); // re-query UsbManager (count will drop to 0)
                updateStatusUI(0); // → gray circle, sleep hint
            });
        }
    }
};
```

```

    }

    // — ATTACH —————
    if (UsbManager.ACTION_USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED.equals(action)) {
        Log.d(TAG, "ACTION_USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED");

        // On attach, device is in the Intent extras under key "device"
        UsbDevice device = (UsbDevice) intent.getExtras().get("device");
        int vid = (device != null) ? device.getVendorId() : -1;
        Log.d(TAG, "--> Vid =" + vid);

        final int finalVid = vid;
        runOnUiThread(() -> {
            refreshDeviceInfo(); // re-query UsbManager (count now ≥ 1)
            if (finalVid == RFID_VID)
                updateStatusUI(1); // → green circle, awake state
        });
    }
}
};

```

3. Initial Device Enumeration on Launch

On startup, query UsbManager before registering the receiver to handle the case where the RFD40 is already connected:

```

UsbManager mUsbManager = getSystemService(UsbManager.class);

HashMap<String, UsbDevice> deviceList = mUsbManager.getDeviceList();
int count = deviceList.size();
Log.d(TAG, "Device List Size: " + count); // e.g. "Device List Size: 1"

for (UsbDevice device : deviceList.values()) {
    Log.d(TAG, "Device VID: " + device.getVendorId()); // e.g. 1504
    Log.d(TAG, "Device PID: " + device.getProductId()); // e.g. 5889
}

updateStatusUI(count); // immediately reflect awake/sleep state

```

4. Status UI Logic

```

private static final int RFID_VID = 1504; // Zebra VID

private void updateStatusUI(int deviceCount) {
    if (deviceCount >= 1) {
        // Green circle – device awake
        mViewStatusCircle.setBackgroundResource(R.drawable.shape_circle_awake);
        mTvStatusIcon.setText("☑ ");
        mTvStatusTitle.setText("RFD40 Awake");
        mTvStatusTitle.setTextColor(0xFF2E7D32);
        mTvStatusHint.setText("Device connected and ready");
    }
}

```

```

    } else {
        // Gray circle – sleep / disconnected
        mViewStatusCircle.setBackgroundResource(R.drawable.shape_circle_sleep);
        mTvStatusIcon.setText("⏸ ");
        mTvStatusTitle.setText("Sleep Mode");
        mTvStatusTitle.setTextColor(0xFF546E7A);
        mTvStatusHint.setText("Hold RFD40 trigger to wake up RFID Reader");
    }
}
}

```

4.1 Interface-Change Counters

The app tracks how many times the USB interface has changed during the current session via two `int` fields and a derived total, surfaced in the **USB INTERFACE CHANGES** card.

```

private int mAttachCount = 0;
private int mDetachCount = 0;

/** Refreshes the attach/detach/total interface-change counters in the UI. */
private void updateCountersUI() {
    mTvAttachCount.setText(String.valueOf(mAttachCount));
    mTvDetachCount.setText(String.valueOf(mDetachCount));
    mTvTotalCount.setText(String.valueOf(mAttachCount + mDetachCount));
}

```

Each receiver branch increments its counter on the UI thread, logs the running value, and refreshes the card:

```

// DETACH branch
mDetachCount++;
appendLog("Detach count = " + mDetachCount);
updateCountersUI();

// ATTACH branch
mAttachCount++;
appendLog("Attach count = " + mAttachCount);
updateCountersUI();

```

Counter	View id	Increments on	Color
Attach	tv_attach_count	ACTION_USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED	green #2E7D32
Detach	tv_detach_count	ACTION_USB_DEVICE_DETACHED	red #C0392B
Total	tv_total_count	mAttachCount + mDetachCount (derived)	blue #0D47A1

Scope: counters are in-memory session values — they start at 0 on launch and are **not** persisted across activity recreation (e.g. rotation). Persist via `onSaveInstanceState` / `SharedPreferences` if cross-session totals are required.

5. Key Log Messages and Their Meaning

Device List Size: 1 → RFD40 present on startup

Device VID: 1504 → Zebra vendor confirmed
Device PID: 5889 → RFD40 product ID

USB action: android.hardware.usb.action.USB_DEVICE_DETACHED
USB device detached
EXTRA_DEVICE Name=/dev/bus/usb/004/004 RFD4031-G00B700-E8:::EA4004
Detach count = 1

USB action: android.hardware.usb.action.USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED
ACTION_USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED
Name=/dev/bus/usb/004/005 RFD4031-G00B700-E8:::EA4005 1504
--> Vid =1504
Attach count = 1

6. Manifest — USB Device Filter (Optional Deep-Link)

To launch the app automatically when the RFD40 is plugged in, add to AndroidManifest.xml:

```
<activity android:name=".MainActivity">
    <intent-filter>
        <action android:name="android.hardware.usb.action.USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED" />
    </intent-filter>
    <meta-data
        android:name="android.hardware.usb.action.USB_DEVICE_ATTACHED"
        android:resource="@xml/usb_device_filter" />
</activity>
```

res/xml/usb_device_filter.xml:

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8"?>
<resources>
    <usb-device vendor-id="1504" product-id="5889" />
</resources>
```

This is **not required** for the runtime receiver — only needed if you want the OS to auto-launch the app on plug-in.

7. Active USB Transport & Power Monitoring (mBatteryReceiver)

Beyond host attach/detach, the app tracks the **USB client transport mode** and **power-cable state** with a second receiver. This distinguishes a *power-only (charging)* cable from a *data-capable (file-transfer / debug)* connection.

7.1 Registration

Registered alongside mUsbReceiver in onCreate():

```
IntentFilter usbStateFilter = new IntentFilter();
usbStateFilter.addAction(ACTION_USB_STATE); // "android.hardware.usb.action.USB_STATE"
usbStateFilter.addAction(Intent.ACTION_POWER_CONNECTED);
usbStateFilter.addAction(Intent.ACTION_POWER_DISCONNECTED);
registerReceiver(mBatteryReceiver, usbStateFilter);
```

```
// Seed the initial mode from the sticky USB_STATE broadcast, if available.
refreshUsbModeFromStickyState();
```

USB_STATE is a **sticky broadcast**, so the current transport state can be read on demand (e.g. on launch or when power connects) without waiting for a fresh change:

```
private void refreshUsbModeFromStickyState() {
    try {
        Intent stickyUsbState = registerReceiver(null, new IntentFilter(ACTION_USB_STATE));
        if (stickyUsbState != null) {
            updateUsbModeFromIntent(stickyUsbState, "sticky");
        } else {
            Log.d(TAGUSB, "USB_STATE sticky intent unavailable");
        }
    } catch (Exception e) {
        Log.w(TAGUSB, "Failed to refresh USB state from sticky intent", e);
    }
}
```

7.2 Receiver branches

```
BroadcastReceiver mBatteryReceiver = new BroadcastReceiver() {
    public void onReceive(Context context, Intent intent) {
        String action = intent.getAction();
        if (action == null) return;

        if (ACTION_USB_STATE.equals(action)) {
            updateUsbModeFromIntent(intent, "broadcast"); // decode transport mode
            return;
        }

        if (Intent.ACTION_POWER_CONNECTED.equals(action)) {
            refreshUsbModeFromStickyState(); // re-read latest transport state
            String mode = usbFileTransferModeActive
                ? "File Transfer / Debug" : "Power-Only (Charging)";
            // → status text + event log
            return;
        }

        if (Intent.ACTION_POWER_DISCONNECTED.equals(action)) {
            usbConnected = false;
            usbConfigured = false;
            usbFileTransferModeActive = false; // reset decoded state
            // → status text + event log
        }
    }
};
```

7.3 Mode-Determination Logic

updateUsbModeFromIntent(Intent, String) decodes boolean extras from the USB_STATE intent:

- **Base flags:** connected, configured
- **Explicit transport functions:** mtp, ptp, mass_storage, adb, rndis

```

private void updateUsbModeFromIntent(Intent usbStateIntent, String source) {
    usbConnected = usbStateIntent.getBooleanExtra(EXTRA_USB_CONNECTED, false);
    usbConfigured = usbStateIntent.getBooleanExtra(EXTRA_USB_CONFIGURED, false);

    boolean explicitDataModeKnown =
        usbStateIntent.hasExtra(EXTRA_USB_MTP) || usbStateIntent.hasExtra(EXTRA_USB_PTP)
        || usbStateIntent.hasExtra(EXTRA_USB_MASS_STORAGE)
        || usbStateIntent.hasExtra(EXTRA_USB_ADB) || usbStateIntent.hasExtra(EXTRA_USB_RNDIS);

    if (explicitDataModeKnown) {
        usbFileTransferModeActive =
            usbStateIntent.getBooleanExtra(EXTRA_USB_MTP, false)
            || usbStateIntent.getBooleanExtra(EXTRA_USB_PTP, false)
            || usbStateIntent.getBooleanExtra(EXTRA_USB_MASS_STORAGE, false)
            || usbStateIntent.getBooleanExtra(EXTRA_USB_ADB, false)
            || usbStateIntent.getBooleanExtra(EXTRA_USB_RNDIS, false);
    } else {
        // Fallback for vendor builds that omit per-function extras:
        // a connected + configured USB is treated as a data-capable link.
        usbFileTransferModeActive = usbConnected && usbConfigured;
    }
}

```

Condition	Decided Mode
Any of mtp / ptp / mass_storage / adb / rndis is true	File Transfer / Debug (usbFileTransferModeActive = true)
No function extras present, but connected && configured	File Transfer / Debug (fallback inference)
ACTION_POWER_CONNECTED while usbFileTransferModeActive == false	Power-Only (Charging)

Fallback rule: custom OS builds may not broadcast the per-function extras. In that case connected && configured is used to infer an active data connection.

8. Lifecycle Summary

```

onCreate()
├─ enumerate existing devices → updateStatusUI(count)
├─ registerReceiver(mUsbReceiver, filter) [ATTACHED/DETACHED]
├─ registerReceiver(mBatteryReceiver, usbStateFilter) [USB_STATE/POWER_*]
├─ refreshUsbModeFromStickyState() [seed initial transport mode]

onReceive(ATTACHED) [mUsbReceiver]
├─ runOnUiThread → mAttachCount++ → updateCountersUI()
├─ refreshDeviceInfo() → updateStatusUI(1) [green]

onReceive(DETACHED) [mUsbReceiver]
├─ runOnUiThread → mDetachCount++ → updateCountersUI()
├─ refreshDeviceInfo() → updateStatusUI(0) [gray]

onReceive(USB_STATE) [mBatteryReceiver]

```

```

    └─ updateUsbModeFromIntent(intent, "broadcast") → appendLog(summary)

onReceive(POWER_CONNECTED)    [mBatteryReceiver]
    └─ refreshUsbModeFromStickyState() → status "POWER CONNECTED" + mode

onReceive(POWER_DISCONNECTED) [mBatteryReceiver]
    └─ reset usb flags → status "POWER DISCONNECTED"

onDestroy()
    └─ unregisterReceiver(mUsbReceiver)
    └─ unregisterReceiver(mBatteryReceiver)

```

9. USB State Log Messages

Transport/power events are logged under the MYUSB_STATE tag:

USB Client action: android.hardware.usb.action.USB_STATE

USB_STATE[broadcast] connected=true, configured=true, mtp=false, ptp=false,
mass_storage=false, adb=true, rndis=false, explicitDataModeKnown=true, fileTransfer=true

USB Client action: android.intent.action.ACTION_POWER_CONNECTED

ACTION_POWER_CONNECTED mode=File Transfer / Debug, connected=true, configured=true, fileTransfer=true

USB Client action: android.intent.action.ACTION_POWER_DISCONNECTED

ACTION_POWER_DISCONNECTED